f) **Hygiene**: Bed sheet, linen and clothing should be clean and changed as when required. This will prevent infection. Bath, body sponging, cleaning at the breast and nipple and toileting of the perineum should be done.

g) **Exercise:** pelvic floor and abdominal exercise to restore muscle tone

7.8 Care of Newborn

First 24 hours is crucial for the newborn where most of the complication occur during that period.

Vital signs: Monitor cardio, pulmonary function and vital signs at frequent intervals.

Temperature: once a day, may be recorded 6 hourly if indicated.

Respiration: Normally regular, smooth and quite with a rate of about 30 - 60 breaths per minute. Any abnormality e.g:- grunting, dyspnoea may be noted.

Skin: Look for cyanosis, jaundice and dehydration.

Head, eyes mouth – must be inspected for any abnormalities and infection.

Umbilical cord: check daily for any inflammation, discharge, smell. Cord usually comes out by 6 – 7 days.

Stool: Number, color and character of stools should be noted. First stool known as meconium is dark, greenish viscid substance. After Subsequent to feeding of the baby, the color of stool changes to brownish yellow.

Urine: Usually passed during or shortly after birth. Most infant pass urine within first 24hours. Urine may stain napkin pink due to the heavy deposits of urates. Napkins should be changed immediately following soiling and local parts are cleaned and kept dry.

Feeding: Encourage demand feeding baby should be breast fed every 3 – 4 hours. Any abnormality like vomiting, distension should be noted.

Underfeeding: It is diagnosed by (1) failure to gain in weight.(2) dissatisfied with feeds (e.g) cry, disturbed sleep, (3) constipation or frequent small stool (or) scanty urine.

Overfeeding: usually occurs at the end of first week. Diagnosed by (1) vomiting soon after feeding, (2) frequent loose bulky stool with undigested curds (3) excoriation over buttock.

Clothing: Should be appropriate for climate.

7.9 Reproductive Health Care and Family Planning

Definition Reproductive Health Care

- Ability to reproduce and regulate fertility
- Safe motherhood – safe pregnancy and child birth with resultant safe mother and infant
- Safe sex with no fear of pregnancy and of controlling diseases.

Components of reproductive health	
• Pre-reproductive years:	Adolescent girl's health problem Nutrition Sex education Contraception and Adolescent pregnancy
• Reproductive years:	Age at marriage (ideally girls 21 – 25 yrs, boys 26 – 30 yrs) Family planning Legal abortion Infections Infertility
• Post-menopausal years:	Education on menopause Screening for genital cancer Prevention and cure of genital cancer

Definition Family Planning

Practices that help individuals or couples achieve the following:

- Avoid unwanted pregnancy

Unit_7_Midwifery_Gen_Nur.indd 167 09-03-2020 14:51:13